

ACML 101 Inorganic Part
Home assignment -1
Crystal Field Theory and its applications to metal complexes

Name: Entry No. Group.....

Please answer all the questions in the provided space and submit them by **December 7, 2024**.

1. Calculate crystal field stabilization energy (CFSE) for the following complexes

- (a) $[\text{Co}(\text{CN})_6]^{3-}$ (b) $[\text{Fe}(\text{CN})_6]^{3-}$ (c) $[\text{CoCl}_6]^{4-}$

Soln.

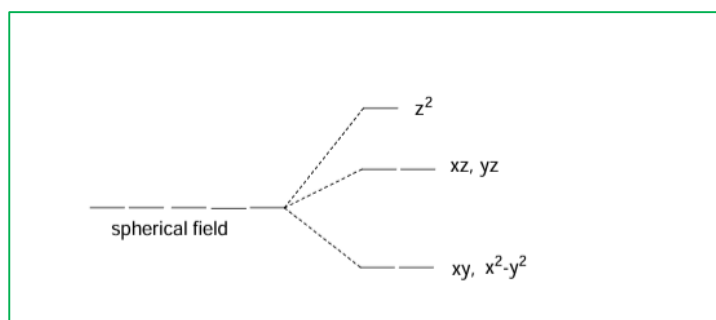
(a) $[\text{Co}(\text{CN})_6]^{3-}$ Co^{3+} , d^6 , CN^- strong ligand; low spin CFSE = $-2.4 \Delta_o + 2P$

(b) $[\text{Fe}(\text{CN})_6]^{3-}$ Fe^{3+} , d^5 low spin CFSE = $-2.0 \Delta_o + 2P$

(c) $[\text{CoCl}_6]^{4-}$ Co^{2+} , d^7 , Cl^- weak ligand high spin CFSE = $-0.8 \Delta_o$

2. Draw the crystal field splitting diagram of d orbitals in a linear complex MX_2 , assuming the ligands (X) to be along the z axis.

Soln. Electron-electron repulsion between M and X will be there only for d orbitals having an z component. Out of these maximum repulsion will be for d_{z^2} since lobes are along the z axis. Next will be d_{xz} and d_{yz} having lobes in between z and another axis and both will be degenerate. The other two orbitals have no z component and will be stabilized to maintain barycentre.



3. Arrange $[\text{Fe}(\text{CN})_6]^{4-}$, $[\text{Fe}(\text{H}_2\text{O})_6]^{2+}$ and $[\text{Mn}(\text{H}_2\text{O})_6]^{2+}$ in decreasing order of metal ion radii with justification.

Discussed in the class

4. $\text{K}_3[\text{Co}(\text{CN})_6]$ is colorless while $\text{K}_3[\text{Co}(\text{C}_2\text{O}_4)_3]$ is colored. Why?

$\text{K}_3[\text{Co}(\text{CN})_6]$ $\text{Co}^{3+} d^6$ LS $t_{2g}^6 e_g^0$; $\text{K}_3[\text{Co}(\text{C}_2\text{O}_4)_3]$ $\text{Co}^{3+} d^6$ HS $t_{2g}^4 e_g^2$
d-d transitions are spin allowed in both cases. However CN^- being a very strong ligand the magnitude of Δ_o will be high and absorption can occur in the UV region for the cyano complex. Therefore it is colorless.

5. Determine if NiFe_2O_4 is a normal or inverse Spinel?

Inverse Spinel, discussed in the class

6. Which of the following octahedral complexes are expected to show very weak tetragonal distortion and why?

(a) $[\text{Cr}(\text{CN})_6]^{4-}$ (b) $[\text{Mn}(\text{H}_2\text{O})_6]^{2+}$ (c) $[\text{Cr}(\text{H}_2\text{O})_6]^{2+}$ and $[\text{Ti}(\text{H}_2\text{O})_6]^{3+}$

Significant JT distortion means degeneracy in the e_g orbitals, discussed in the class